

## **BYLAWS OF THETA LAMBDA CHAPTER**

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### **ARTICLE I – NAME**

The name of this chapter shall be the Theta Lambda Chapter of Sigma Alpha Iota, located at Furman University in Greenville, South Carolina.

### **ARTICLE II - GENERAL PROVISIONS**

- Section 1. General Policies and Procedures. Any Fraternity procedures or obligations, either chapter or individual, which are not specifically defined in these Bylaws, shall be handled in accordance with established procedures as prescribed in appropriate Fraternity publications.
- Section 2. Abbreviations. The following abbreviations shall be used as appropriate throughout these bylaws:
- CPM – Chapter Procedures Manual  
GPA – Grade Point Average

### **ARTICLE III – MEMBERSHIP**

- Section 1. Eligibility Requirements for Student Membership.
- A. Membership is open to any female student who has completed at least one semester of study at Furman University.
  - B. A Prospective Member-in-Training must have a sincere interest in music and be willing to uphold the ideals of Sigma Alpha Iota.
  - C. A Prospective Member-in-Training must have completed or be currently enrolled in one or more courses in music.
  - D. The minimum, overall cumulative grade point average required for membership is 2.5.
- Section 2. Title IX Status and Statement Against Discrimination. Sigma Alpha Iota is a Title IX exempt organization. Sigma Alpha Iota does not discriminate against women students on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, creed, political belief, disability, age, marital status, veteran status, or sexual orientation.

- Section 3. Exception to Active Membership. A member may become locally inactive for one semester. Study abroad terms will not count toward this one semester, as some programs are more than one semester (ex. Chinese Study Away Program).
- A. A member must submit a written request for inactive status. National dues must still be paid. Local dues must be paid in accordance with the dates listed in Appendix C.
  - B. Reasons for inactive status shall include, but not be limited to: student teaching away from campus; study abroad; internship; financial issues; medical issues; family issues; class conflicts; work conflicts.
  - C. Other extenuating circumstances will be considered as they arise.
  - D. While inactive a member is responsible for national dues, but local dues are waived.
  - E. A member will not be granted inactive status until they have paid all outstanding debts. If they fail to do so, they will be reported to the chapter's financial advisor, and to National Headquarters.
  - F. An inactive member may not vote, may not hold office, may not serve on committees or serve as a committee chairman, may not be a sponsor for an Member-in-Training, may not participate in Ritual ceremonies, and is not eligible for fraternity or chapter honors and awards.
  - G. All inactive members are encouraged to attend chapter musicales, ritual ceremonies and other designated public events as an audience member when possible.
- Section 4. Financial Obligations of Membership.
- A. All members must pay annual dues in a timely manner in order to be in good financial standing.
  - B. Members who have not met their financial obligations in full by the end of the year will be considered a member not-in-good-standing and will be reported to National Headquarters as delinquent.
- Section 5. Voting Privileges of Membership.
- A. Only members in good standing are privileged to vote on chapter business.
  - B. To be in good standing, a member must:
    - 1. Pay all dues and fees in full by the set due date.
    - 2. Attend all chapter meetings and events, unless excused.
    - 3. Maintain a minimum, overall cumulative GPA of 2.5.
    - 4. Perform all requirements in regards to receptions, ushering, fundraising, musicale, local philanthropy, and national philanthropy.
- Section 6. Alumnae Member Status. Members are granted alumnae status upon graduation or termination of studies and are encouraged to affiliate with a local alumnae chapter and join the Sigma Alpha Iota Alumnae Association.

#### **ARTICLE IV – MEMBER-IN-TRAINING**

- Section 1. Invitations to Membership. After all membership eligibility criteria are met, invitations to membership are issued upon a two-thirds affirmative vote of the chapter in accordance with the CPM.
- Section 2. Sponsors. Each Member-in-Training will be assigned a sponsor.
- A. Service as a sponsor shall be voluntary.

- B. Sponsors shall be assigned as follows: After consulting with the Sisterhood, the Vice President, Membership shall choose members in good standing to sponsor Members-in-Training.
- C. Sponsors are responsible for assisting and advising the Members-in-Training, ensuring that they fulfill the requirements for initiation into the Fraternity and preparing them to meet the responsibilities and expectations of membership.

Section 3. Requirements for Initiation. In order to be initiated into the Fraternity, a Member-in-Training must:

- A. Pay all fees in full by the set due date.
- B. Demonstrate her musical ability by participating in a membership recital. This participation requirement may be fulfilled by a performance as a soloist, as a member of an ensemble, or, if not a musical performer, by a demonstration of her interest in and knowledge of music.
- C. Pass the National Membership Examination.
- D. Fulfill the requirements of the Member-in-Training program.

Section 4. Fees.

- A. The Member-in-Training fee must be paid in full at the time of the Pledging Ceremony. This fee is not refundable.
- B. The initiation fee, which includes the life leasehold of an official member Badge, must be paid in full at the time of the National Membership Examination.

Section 5. Statement Against Hazing.

- A. Sigma Alpha Iota condemns the hazing of prospective initiates, and Theta Lambda Chapter will neither conduct nor participate in hazing activities of any kind.
- B. Furman University Statement on Hazing
  - a. Hazing is inconsistent with the values of Furman University and is a violation of South Carolina law. It is the responsibility of each student of a given organization to prevent and confront hazing within organizations. Any organization found responsible of hazing will be placed on probation or suspended from the University.
  - b. Hazing Policy
    - i. No organization, student or alumnus shall conduct or condone hazing activities. "Hazing" is defined as any intentional, knowing, or reckless act, occurring on or off campus, by one person alone or acting with others, directed against a student, that endangers the mental or physical health or safety of a student for the purpose of pledging, being initiated into, affiliating with, holding office in, or maintaining membership in an organization or on an athletic team.
  - c. Hazing includes any type of:
    - i. Action taken or situation created, intentionally, whether on or off University premises, to produce mental or physical discomfort, embarrassment, harassment, or ridicule.
    - ii. Physical brutality including, but not limited to, whipping, beating, striking, branding, electronic shocking, placing of a harmful substance on the body, or similar activity;
      - 1. including, but not limited to, sleep deprivation, exposure to the elements, confinement in a small space, calisthenics, or other activity that subjects the student to an unreasonable risk of harm or that adversely affects the mental or physical health or safety of the student;

- iii. Activity involving consumption of a food, liquid, alcohol beverage, drug, or other substance that subjects the student to an unreasonable risk of harm or that adversely affects the mental or physical health or safety of the student;
  - iv. Activity that intimidates or threatens the student with ostracism, that subjects the student to extreme mental stress, shame, or humiliation, that adversely affects the mental health or dignity of the student or discourages the student from entering or remaining registered in an educational institution, or that may reasonably be expected to cause a student to leave the organization or the institution rather than submit to acts described in this subdivision. Examples include but are not limited to quests, treasure hunts, scavenger hunts, road trips; wearing of public apparel which is conspicuous and not normally in good taste; and late work sessions that interfere with scholastic activities; and
  - v. An Activity that induces, causes, or requires the student to perform a duty or task that involves a violation of the Student Conduct Code or South Carolina State Law.
- d. Definition of a New Member
  - i. At Furman, the term “new member” is used in place of the term “pledge.” “New member” is defined as any person who has been accepted by, is considering an offer of membership from, or is in the process of qualifying for membership in an organization. “New member education” means any action or activity related to becoming a member of an organization. “Organization” means a fraternity, sorority, association, corporation, order, society, corps, club, or service, social, or similar group, whose members are primarily students.
- e. Personal Hazing Offense
  - i. A person commits a hazing offense if the person:
    - 1. engages in hazing;
    - 2. solicits, encourages, directs, aids, or attempts to aid another in engaging in hazing;
    - 3. permits hazing to occur; or
    - 4. has firsthand knowledge of the planning of a specific hazing incident involving a student or has firsthand knowledge that a specific hazing incident has occurred and knowingly fails to report that knowledge in writing to Student Life office or other appropriate official of the institution.
- f. Organization Hazing Offense
  - i. An organization commits an offense if the organization condones or encourages hazing or if an officer or any combination of members, pledges, or alumni of the organization commits or assists in the commission of hazing.
- g. Consent Not a Defense
  - i. It is not a defense under this policy that the person against whom the hazing was directed consented to or acquiesced in the hazing activity. South Carolina state law does not permit a person to consent to hazing.
- h. Retaliation
  - i. It is both unlawful and a violation of Furman’s Student Conduct Code for members of the Furman community to retaliate against any individual who files a complaint, testifies, or participates in any manner in an investigation or proceeding. The accused and/or those allied with the accused are prohibited from retaliating (including intimidating, threatening, coercing, or in any way discriminating against the individual) because of the individual’s complaint or participation. Furman will vigorously enforce this prohibition against retaliation.

- i. Furman's Campus Conduct Hotline
  - i. To report any hazing activity, you may call Furman's Campus Conduct Hotline at 866-943-5787.
- j. Greek Hazing Hotline
  - i. If you are part of the Greek community and are uncomfortable about speaking to Furman officials about the hazing activity, you may call the Greek Hazing Hotline at 1-888-NOT-HAZE (888-668-4293).

## **ARTICLE V – OFFICERS**

- Section 1. Elected Officers. The elected officers of the chapter shall be: President; Vice President, Membership; Vice President, Ritual; Corresponding Secretary; Recording Secretary; Treasurer; Sergeant-at-Arms; and Editor.
- Section 2. Duties of Officers. Duties of officers are as listed in the CPM. Additional duties are:
- A. Corresponding Secretary shall be in charge of supplying ushers for Furman University Music Department events.
  - B. Editor shall act as the Publicity Committee, creating and distributing all advertisements needed by the chapter.
  - C. Treasurer shall serve on the Fundraising Committee.
  - D. Sergeant-at-Arms shall:
    - 1. Act as the head of the Bylaw Review Committee in the fall
    - 2. Be responsible for presenting the changes to the sisterhood and updating the electronic copy of the Bylaws and Appendix C (Local Policy and Procedures).
- Section 3. Term Length of Offices. The term of office begins with the installation of officers in March but no later than April 15 and ends when the new officers are installed in March but no later than April 15 of the next year in accordance with the CPM.
- Section 4. Vacancies in Office. Vacancies in office will be filled in accordance with the procedures outlined in the CPM.

## **ARTICLE VI - NOMINATIONS AND ELECTIONS**

- Section 1. Qualifications for Election. To be elected to office a member must:
- A. Be in good standing as defined in Article III, Section 5B
  - B. Each candidate must submit a written application by late February or the first meeting in March when discussion shall take place.
  - C. All Presidential Candidates are recommended to have prior leadership experience and familiarity for the workings of the Executive Board.
  - D. Each candidate must be available for the entire school year of which she wishes to serve on the Executive Board.
- Section 2. Nominating Committee. A nominating committee of 5 members shall be elected by the chapter in accordance with the CPM.
- Section 3. Nominations. Nominations will be conducted in accordance with the procedures outlined in the CPM.
- Section 4. Elections. Elections will be conducted in accordance with the procedures outlined in the CPM.

## ARTICLE VII - EXECUTIVE BOARD

- Section 1. Membership. The executive board shall be composed of all elected chapter officers.
- Section 2. Responsibilities. Duties of the executive board are as outlined in the CPM.
- Section 3. Meetings. The executive board shall meet before each Formal Business Meeting and is to meet with the advisory committee as necessary.
- Section 4. Quorum. Quorum shall be designated as two-thirds of the chapter's executive board membership.

## ARTICLE VIII – MEETINGS

- Section 1. Chapter Meetings. Chapter meetings are business meetings that are held at regular times.
- A. Formal business meetings shall take place at least once each month and shall include ritual.
  - B. Appropriate business attire is required.
  - C. Informal chapter meetings shall take place on weeks when there is no formal business meeting.
  - D. Quorum shall be designated as two-thirds of the chapter's active membership.
- Section 2. Special Meetings. Special meetings are meetings of the entire chapter held for emergency purposes, for business that could not be planned for in advance but must be transacted before the next scheduled meeting.
- A. The Executive Board may call special meetings.
  - B. Meetings may be called if an emergency arises that must be addressed with the chapter outside of normal meetings or if a rehearsal is necessary for ritual.
  - C. Notification of the meeting must be made at least 72 hours in advance.

## ARTICLE IX – COMMITTEES

- Section 1. Standing Committees. Standing committees are ongoing committees which have continuing responsibilities throughout the year.
- A. Standing committees of the chapter shall include, but not be limited to: Social, Membership, Sisterhood, Fraternity Education, Fundraising, National Philanthropy, Local Outreach, Publicity, Receptions, Song Leader
  - B. Each member will fill out a questionnaire stating her preferences as to what committee she will be on and whether or not she is willing to chair a committee. The Executive Board shall then assign committees based on this information.
  - C. The Executive Board will select members of each committee to serve as the chairman.
  - D. Each committee will consist of a chair and at least one other member.
  - E. Duties of the committees are as listed in the CPM. Additional duties are:
    - 1. Social Committee shall:
      - a) Organize events including but not limited to: Semi-Formal, the Viennese Ball, and Formal. This requires brainstorming themes and planning event schedules while working closely with the chapter treasurer.
      - b) Organize SAI's participation in homecoming events and Relay for Life.
    - 2. Membership shall:
      - a) Assist the chapter VP Membership in any way necessary.
      - b) Help the VPM to plan recruitment events, train MITs for the MIT exam, and plan the MIT retreat.
      - c) Ensure that the MITs have an enjoyable MIT process, while becoming educated in how to uphold SAI's mission.

3. Fundraising shall:
    - a) Design a collection of Furman Music related apparel for sale and maintain an inventory of the same.
    - b) Keep an up-to-date list of who has completed their fundraising requirements.
    - c) Maintain an inventory of all merchandise.
    - d) Coordinate apparel sales opportunities with the Department of Music.
    - e) Organize and manage the Fermata Café fundraising event.
  4. Sisterhood shall:
    - a) Organize retreats for the chapter members.
    - b) Organize activities at chapter meetings meant to aid the members in learning about one another while fostering sisterhood bonding.
    - c) Organize at least one sisterhood retreat per semester.
  5. Local Outreach shall:
    - a) Organize opportunities for members to meet their local philanthropy requirements.
    - b) Keep an up-to-date list of who has completed these requirements.
  6. Receptions shall:
    - a) Contact all senior music performers presenting a recital as well as the music department to offer them the services of Sigma Alpha Iota receptions.
    - b) Make all food purchases for the receptions.
    - c) Organize the sisterhood to staff the events.
    - d) Maintain an up-to-date list of who has completed their receptions requirements each semester.
    - e) Maintain an orderly receptions closet.
  7. Song Leader(s) shall:
    - a) Teach the sisterhood new songs while refining older songs during Song Meetings.
    - b) Compile a binder of songs to be used during Local Philanthropy events.
    - c) Act in conjunction with the Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia Song Leader to organize the Sigma Alpha Iota/ Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia Christmas Concert.
    - d) Organize the monthly musicale event at formal meetings and whenever requested by the President.
  8. Publicity shall:
    - a) Assist the editor in publicizing for any events, both within the music department and the broader community.
    - b) Assist the editor in maintaining the SAI bulletin board.
  9. National Philanthropy shall:
    - a) Organize an event that raises money to support a national philanthropy of the chapter's choosing. Events in the past have included a 5K race and benefit concerts.
- F. The term of the committee chairman starts the previous year, when they are chosen by the Executive Board. It continues until the Executive Board selects a new chairman for the committee. On average their term will be for one full year.

Section 2. Special Committees. Special committees may be created by the chapter as needed to function until completion of a specified assignment. These committees include, but are not limited to, Homecoming, Bylaws, Nominating, and Honors Committees.

Section 3. Ex-Officio Committee Membership. The President shall serve as an ex-officio member on all committees except for the Nominating Committee.

## **ARTICLE X – CHAPTER ADVISORS/ADVISORY COMMITTEE**

- Section 1. Composition. An advisory committee of three members shall be formed in accordance with the CPM. If unable to form an advisory committee, the chapter will select an advisor in accordance with the CPM.
- Section 2. Meetings. The advisory committee shall meet at least once each semester by itself and with the executive board bi-monthly beginning with the first month of the academic year in accordance with the CPM.
- Section 3. Responsibilities. Responsibilities and duties of advisors are as outlined in the CPM.

## **ARTICLE XI - HONORS AND AWARDS**

- Section 1. Honors Committee. The chapter will form an Honors Committee of three members in January in accordance with the CPM. Duties of the Honors Committee shall be as outlined in the CPM.
- Section 2. National Honors and Awards. The Chapter may present National Honors and Awards in accordance with the National Bylaws and the CPM.
- Section 3. Local Honors and Awards. The Chapter of Theta Lambda makes the following local awards that have been approved by the province officer and do not resemble national awards in name and form, in accordance with the CPM.
- A. Saint Cecilia's Scholarship (pending adequate funding)
  - B. This is awarded to a returning undergraduate student involved in the music department that is not a member of Sigma Alpha Iota and has not already received the award. This person may be either male or female. Criteria for this award shall include but are not limited to: financial need, strong musical abilities, and strong contribution within the department.
  - C. The potential recipients shall be nominated by members of the chapter and decided upon by a two-thirds majority vote of the sisterhood. They shall be notified of the award at the Spring Honors Recital.

## **ARTICLE XII-PARLIAMENTARY AUTHORITY**

The rules contained in the current edition of *Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised* shall govern the chapter in all cases to which they are applicable and in which they are not inconsistent with these Bylaws and any special rules of order the chapter may adopt.

## **ARTICLE XIII - AMENDMENT OF BYLAWS**

Amendments to these Bylaws may be proposed in writing at any regular meeting and voted upon at the next regular meeting. A two-thirds vote is required.